Bow Valley College

Course Outline

HCAD1404

Providing Person-Centred Care & Comfort

Winter 2026 - Current

Last Updated: 12/17/2025 11:36:36 AM

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Bow Valley College is situated in Treaty 7 territory. We honour the territories and Peoples of: the Blackfoot Confederacy, which includes the Siksika, Kainai, Piikani, and Amskapi Piikani (Blackfeet) First Nations; the Tsuut'ina First Nation; and the Îyâxe Nakoda, which includes the Goodstoney, Chiniki, and Bearspaw First Nations. We also acknowledge the historical Northwest Métis homeland and the Otipemisiwak Métis Government of Alberta, districts 4, 5, and 6 in Battle River territory.

HCAD1404 Providing Person-Centred Care & Comfort

COURSE DESCRIPTION

In this course, the learner will learn to support clients to maintain their independence and meet their care needs according to individual care plans. The learner will acquire the skills and knowledge needed to assist clients with daily grooming and hygiene and to assist clients to walk and use mobility aids and wheel chairs safely. The learner will learn several methods for carrying out client lifts and transfers, with a focus on client safety and comfort. Upon completion of the course, the learner will have an excellent baseline knowledge of standards for meeting client nutritional needs and strict guidelines in safe food handling as set out in minimum provincial expectations. Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

REQUISITES	None
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	5
HOURS	75
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	Yes
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	No

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong students. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that students acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Describe knowledge of providing person-centred care and comfort within the HCA role in the following skill areas: client grooming and personal hygiene, bathing, bed making, assisting with elimination, client mobility, positioning, transfers, and lifts, assisting at mealtimes and with food safety, and using basic knowledge of body systems.	1,8
2	Define evidence-informed practice and guidelines for assisting with each of the activities of daily living skills.	2,4
3	Describe the importance of the client's strengths, needs, rights, preferences, and expectations, and their willingness and ability to participate in their care.	6,9
4	Demonstrate ethical person-centred care related to assisting with activities of daily living skills and following the client care plan in the acute and continuing care settings (home care, long-term care, and supportive living).	4,6,8
5	Identify knowledge of the collaborative teams' roles and responsibilities within the assistance of each of the activities of daily living skills.	1,4
6	Describe key elements of the palliative care approach that can be applied to the planning, implementation, and assistance of activities of daily living skills.	8,9
7	Demonstrate competence (knowledge, skills, behaviours, and attitudes) by applying evidence-informed practice and guidelines when assisting with activities of daily living skills.	1,2
8	Apply the principles of professional and accurate communication through instruction, delivery, reporting, and documentation of activities of daily living skills.	1,2,8
9	Apply communication techniques and strategies that support diverse clients displaying responsive behaviours when assisting with activities of daily living skills.	1,6
10	Demonstrate client and personal safety by recognizing and responding to safety hazards, near misses, reporting abuse, following infection prevention and control principles, conducting client transfers, and handling and operating health equipment safely.	1,2,4,8

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
Week 1	Module 1: Assisting with Client Mobility
Week 2	Module 1: Assisting with Client Mobility
Week 3	Module 2: Positioning, Transfers, and Lifts
Week 4	Module 2: Positioning, Transfers, and Lifts
Week 5	Module 3: Client Grooming and Personal Hygiene
Week 6	Module 3: Client Grooming and Personal Hygiene
Week 7	Reading Week (dates may vary)
Week 8	Module 3: Client Grooming and Personal Hygiene
Week 9	Module 4: Bathing the Client and Bed Making
Week 10	Module 5: Assisting with Elimination
Week 11	Module 6: Assist with Nutrition and Mealtimes/Module 7: Food Safety
Week 12	Consolidation Lab
Week 13	Consolidation Lab
Week 14	Final Exam

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1-10	Final Exam	100%
1-10	Completion of Lab Skills	Pass/Fail

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

As per the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum and Licensing Policies, learners are required to achieve a minimum grade of B- (70%) to pass all theory and lab courses, including this course. As well, in courses HCAD1401, HCAD1403, HCAD1404, HCAD1406, and HCAD1407 learners must achieve a "pass" on all lab skills outlined in the Lab Skills Guide.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	Percentage	Grade Point	Description
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered
C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum learner guide: Course 4 providing person-centred & comfort. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum lab skills guide courses 1, 3, 4, 6 and 7. Edmonton, AB.

(*A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore*.)

Sorrentino, S., Remmert, L., Wilk, M., Newmaster, R. (2021). Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker– Text, Workbook and Clinical Skills: Skills for Nurse Assisting. (5th Canadian ed.) Toronto: Elsevier Canada or current edition. (ISBN: 9780323880626)

OR

Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker Elsevier eBook on VitalSource, 5th Cdn. (Purchase on the Evolve site. The ISBN is: 9780323711661)

Canadian Clinical Skills: Skills for Personal Support Workers, 1st Cdn Edition by Elsevier

HCA Lab Kit (Available for purchase at the bookstore)

Bow Valley College Health Care Aide Program Scrub Uniform (Grey/Black) (Available for purchase at the Bookstore)

Latex-free gloves (100 gloves).

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

Additional References:

Alberta Health Services. (2016, July 5). It's your move annual update. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://ahammso1.https.internapcdn.net/ahammso1/Content/AHS_Website/modules/iym/presentation_content/external_files/IYM_course_notes_EXT.pdf

Alberta Health Services. (2021). Ergonomics Training. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/careers/Page12772.aspx

Alberta Health Services. [AHSChannel] (2015, August 27). Safe client handling. One and two-person transfers with belt. [Video]. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://www.youtube.com/watch?list=PLi1tOF1I5ZoX5BYtKBy-S2pSYm3n_Az4K&v=76mO6TfTk7M

Alberta Government. (2018). Alberta Health Care Aide Competency Profile. Retrieved on November 10, 2021 from https://open.alberta.ca/dataset/e1fbd562-1571-40b8-bc17-71687dab444c/resource/9e34d246-c389-4753-bda4-f53a77e02f80/download/ah-hca-core-competency-profile-2018.pdf

Alzheimer's Association. (2021). Food and Eating. Retrieved November 21, 2021, from https://www.alz.org/help-support/caregiving/daily-care/food-eating

Batchelor, M. [MelissaBPhD]. (2018, May 31). Handfeeding Assistance in Alzheimer's disease and dementia. [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eN_PMpqmtto

Public Health Agency of Canada. (2013). Something you ate? Episode 4: Protecting yourself [Video file]. Retrieved November 21, 2021, from https://www.canada.ca/en/public-health/services/food-safety/videos/something-you-episode-4-protecting-yourself.html

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 14. Transferring a client to a chair or wheelchair. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 14. Moving the client to a stretcher. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 14. Transferring the client using a mechanical lift. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 14. Positioning the client in bed. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 15. Helping the client to walk. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 17. Giving a back massage. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 17. Giving perineal care to a client with female genitalia. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 17. Giving perineal care to a client with male genitalia. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 17. Providing Denture Care. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 17. Providing oral hygiene. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 17. Assisting with a tub bath or shower. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 17. Giving a complete or partial bed bath. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 18. Applying anti-embolic stockings. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 18. Assisting with undressing and dressing. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 18. Brushing and combing the client's hair. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 18. Shaving a client. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Chapter 18. Changing an incontinence brief. Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students with documented disabilities (e.g., mental health diagnosis, learning disability, physical disability, etc.) may qualify for classroom and/or exam accommodations. The College can also assist students who may be experiencing difficulties with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. Students who need academic and exam accommodations based on other protected grounds may also make those requests.
It is the student's responsibility to request academic accommodations. Students are encouraged to contact Accessibility Services as early as possible.

Visit: Learner Success Services- 1st floor south campus
Contact: accessibility@bowvalleycollege.ca or 403-410-1440
BVC Central: Accessibility Services

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Student Code of Conduct (500-1-1), Student Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1-10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13).
Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by students is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Academic Integrity:

At Bow Valley College, we value academic integrity. This means everyone at the college, including students, faculty, and staff, follow principles that foster ethical and truthful ways of being in their work and studies. The college is committed to integrity being infused in all aspects of work and studies. It is important to act with integrity in everything you do at the college. The values you practice at the college are the same values that will inform and guide your career. If someone breaks from the principles that are in agreement with academic integrity policy, the college is committed to carefully investigating and fairly handling any issues related to academic integrity and academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct is acting in such a way as to give yourself or others an unfair academic advantage or disadvantage. Examples of this can include:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating on tests or exams
- Tampering with or falsifying any grades or documents
- Sharing assignments or exam information with others
- Aiding others in dishonest acts
- Using artificial intelligence in graded work without the explicit consent of the instructor
- Recording anything in the classroom or other instructional area without permission

Breaking from the principles that guide academic integrity can lead to educative interventions and/or punitive measures. It is the student's responsibility to review the Academic Integrity Policy. Please review the following resources:

- Academic Integrity Policy Summary
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Academic Integrity Procedure

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student work. Students acknowledge that any course work or
essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where either the course instructor, a representative of Bow Valley College, or a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, https://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/academic-calendar.
Students are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements. You may use the recordings only for educational purposes. You must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission. Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 4 (c) of the Protection of Privacy Act, Alberta (POPA) to deliver academic programming, support student flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. Bow Valley College uses automated systems to generate content and make decisions, recommendations and predictions, and your personal information may be included in these automated systems.

Your personal information will be used and disclosed in accordance with sections 12 and 13 of POPA and protected in accordance with section 10 of POPA. If you have any questions about the collection, use, disclosure or protection of personal information, please contact the Access and Privacy Officer at privacy@bowvalleycollege.ca.